Neal T. Gillespie

Austin, TX 78729 • nealtgill@gmail.com • (513) 807-1705 • LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/neal01

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Hiring Committee
McKinney Public Library
City of McKinney
401 E. Virginia Street, McKinney, TX 75069

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying for the Library Technician position in Community Engagement with the McKinney Public Library. Planning programs, lining up the people who make them happen, promoting them, running them, and then finding out whether they worked is what my job already consists of. The programs happen to be fundraising campaigns rather than library programming, but the sequence is the same one your posting describes.

My title is Direct Mail Production Manager at Young Americans for Liberty. I run printed fundraising campaigns from concept through mail date: direct mail letters and their reply devices, printed proposals and reports prepared for major donors, booklets, invitations, inserts and newsletters. I design the schedule, coordinate the outside vendors and internal departments who produce each piece, keep several concurrent projects on their dates, produce the promotional material, and report afterward on how each one performed so the next round is built on something more than instinct.

Your duties include evaluating current program and outreach models, and that is the part I would be most useful on soonest. I manage the archive of every printed piece we produce, and I designed the SQL database behind it, set a consistent record for every piece covering mail code, campaign, date, format, audience and vendor, cataloged several campaign years against that standard, and built a searchable interface over it. The collection now serves the whole department at once. I also built the Free Knowledge Library, a digital library of political literature drawn from across the ideological spectrum, where I designed the website, the database and the classification scheme and built the catalog readers search, and StateTrack, a public website publishing state campaign finance records for all fifty states. I am comfortable measuring whether a program reached anyone rather than guessing.

The public-facing side is familiar too. At the University of Austin I was the on-site point of contact for visitor tours of the campus library, hosting guests and answering their questions about the collections, and I handled the intake of donated books the university was building that library from, including a complete set of the *Harvard Classics*. I coordinated donor events with internal departments and outside partners, and earlier I ran event registration, check-in and on-site logistics for conferences serving up to a thousand attendees. Before that I staffed the public service window at Chapman University’s Fowler School of Law as the first person students talked to.

I am building toward this as a career rather than sampling it. I have begun the ALA’s Library Support Staff Certification, I begin a Library and Information Services certificate at Central Community College in the spring with a master’s in library and information science to follow, and I hold a valid California driver’s license. I should say plainly that I am able to relocate. I am in Austin now, and I am willing to move anywhere in Texas a position requires.

Thank you for your consideration. I would welcome the chance to talk about the role.

Sincerely,

Neal T. Gillespie